the traditional Mimouna feast (a North African–Jewish traditional celebration) after Passover, nor to give an interview that totally misrepresented the political situation in Israel to *Meet the Press*. What a trickster! The Mimouna is no big deal, but another concession to the Orthodox parties is. Military service for the students of yeshivot will either be completely scrapped or seriously cut short, in return for whatever financial payback to the army. Zahal (as the IDF is also known), which up to now aimed at being the whole people's army, will be the army of only one part of the population.

Monday, April 17

Tomorrow is Holocaust Remembrance Day in Israel, still a significant commemoration for a diminishing segment of the population. The elaborate ceremonies are mostly politicized and greatly overdone, yet they keep some relevance for that segment and it is good that they take place. The moment when in mid-morning, at the sound of a siren, all cars stop and the drivers get out and stand at attention, together with all the pedestrians, remains extremely moving. On the other hand, the organized school trips to the camps in Poland have something brash and uncouth about them.

In the war years, the Yishuv (the Jewish residents in Palestine before the establishment of the State of Israel) did not attach much importance to what was happening in Europe, except, as Ben-Gurion put it, that nobody would remain to build the Jewish state. This was not a glorious page in the history of Ben-Gurion's leadership, nor of the mainly socialist political elites of Eretz Israel. This indifference was quite widespread.

After the end of the war, notwithstanding the Yishuv's efforts to bring survivors to the Land of Israel, those same leaders established a clear distinction between "ordinary survivors" who were just "dust" and the ghetto fighters who could be compared with the fighters in Eretz Israel.